FETA PDO

THE BASICS



MAKE:	Soft
SUB MAKE:	Predominantly Rennet set cheese for further ripening
POST-MAKE:	Flavoured or Smoked
TYPICAL AGE PROFILE:	Minimum two months
APPROXIMATE WEIGHT(S):	various
GEOGRAPHICAL ORIGIN:	Greece, comprising Mainland Greece, Péloponnèse Thessalia, Epirus, Macedonia, Thrace and Lesbos.
PROTECTED STATUS:	PDO - must be made in Greece with sheep's milk (minimum 70% sheeps milk)
SPECIES OF MILKING ANIMAL:	Goat, Sheep
BREED OF GOAT:	Not Specified
BREED OF SHEEP:	Not Specified
RAW/PASTEURISED MILK:	Examples of both depending on cheesemaker
VEGETARIAN/ANIMAL RENNET:	Examples of both depending on cheesemaker
COMMONLY ENCOUNTERED VARIATIONS:	N/A

THE STORY

Cheesemaking was a gift of the gods, according to Greek mythology, while the Cyclops' cave in Homer's Odyssey was filled with a sheeps cheese believed to be the forerunner of Feta. The ancient cheese was in danger of losing its identity in the 1990s when it was industrially produced across Europe. But after a long campaign, Greece secured a PDO for the cheese in 2002 meaning Feta can now only be made in Greece with sheep and goats' milk. The hardy animals roam the mountainous landscape grazing on a diverse range of plants, which is expressed in creamy, fragrant milk. Feta is made following the soft cheese process. The curd is cut and may be stirred before acidification in the mould during draining. Most cheeses are salted and matured in brine, but some traditional versions are dry salted in barrels – the salt drawing whey from the cheese which forms the brine.

THE CHARACTER

Feta has no rind and is crumbly in texture with small holes and cracks. Dairy and herbaceous notes predominate with a salty finish.

PERFECT PARTNERS:

Great in pies, pastries and salads, the saltiness of the cheese also makes it a good match for crisp, refreshing beers, such as Pilsner.

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